

WORLDS

Despite frequently raising the bogey of a Third Alternative Front, the CPI(M) seems content with the status quo that allows it to run with the hare and hunt with the hound



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government whenever it can, just as it has been doing for these past four years. The fig leaf to justify the continuation of the status quo is hardly an original one—"to keep the communal and fascist BJP out of power".

However, CPI(M) has realised in the last four years that to exercise maximum power without responsibility it would need to acquire more muscle for itself and weaken the position of the Congress. Hence, the carrot called the Third Alternative, which the party hopes will be able to rope in outfits like SP, TDP and perhaps a few from NDA as

well. The meet reiterated the stand that it would not join any front or alliance with the Congress. But the party won't abhor an indirect alliance such as the one in Tamil Nadu, where both CPI(M) and the Congress are partners in the DMK-led alliance. "We have never entered into any alliance with the Congress anywhere. But how can we ask another party not to have an alliance with the Congress?", asks CPI(M) General Secretary Prakash Karat. Although CPI(M) leaders say it would be their endeavour to encourage some "secular parties trapped in NDA"

BLAMES CONGRESS

PRICE RISE: Says UPA Government did not take necessary steps

NON-FULFILMENT OF CMP: Accuses the Congress of deviating from the Common Minimum Programme

AGRARIAN CRISIS: Says UPA only pays lip service to farmers

UNEMPLOYMENT: Attacks UPA for not doing enough for youth

INDO-US NUCLEAR DEAL: Accuses Congress of selling out the national interest

TAKES CREDIT FOR

NREGA: Says it was pressure from Left that forced the Government to enact the legislation

TRIBAL FOREST RIGHTS ACT: Again claims responsibility for the Act

RIGHT TO INFORMATION ACT: Corners the praise for the hugely popular Act that brings in transparency

CURTAILING DISINVESTMENT: UPA would have sold out but for them

STOPPING FDI IN RETAIL: Claims Left kept MNC invasion at bay

SOUL SEARCHING

CORRUPTION: Admits party members are no strangers to corrupt practices

DISPLAY OF WEALTH AND LUXURY: Says partymen are beginning to copy the "capitalistic" lifestyle

ACCEPTING DOWRY: Once the party found mates for cadres; now it concedes they fall for dowry

CASTEIST AND RELIGIOUS PRACTICES: Admits atheists are at a premium